

VOCABULARY · BAND 7+

Topic-wise collocations with ready-made sentences. Learn chunks, not single words — collocations are what separate Band 6 from Band 7.

Education

Collocation	Use it like this
lifelong learning	Lifelong learning is now essential, as skills become outdated within a decade.
tailored instruction	Tailored instruction helps weaker students progress without holding back the class.
academic pressure	Relentless academic pressure can harm teenagers' mental health.
rote memorisation	Rote memorisation yields marks but rarely produces understanding.
extracurricular activities	Extracurricular activities build teamwork and leadership alongside grades.

Environment

Collocation	Use it like this
carbon emissions	Cutting carbon emissions demands coordinated international action.
renewable energy	Investment in renewable energy creates jobs while reducing pollution.
irreversible damage	Deforestation causes irreversible damage to biodiversity.
sustainable practices	Factories are adopting sustainable practices to meet new regulations.
environmental degradation	Environmental degradation hits poor communities hardest.

Technology

Collocation	Use it like this
rapid technological advances	Rapid technological advances have reshaped how we work.
digital literacy	Digital literacy is as fundamental as reading and writing.
face-to-face interaction	Screens cannot fully replace face-to-face interaction.
data privacy concerns	Data privacy concerns grow as apps collect more personal information.
automate routine tasks	Machines now automate routine tasks, freeing people for creative work.

Health

Collocation	Use it like this
sedentary lifestyle	A sedentary lifestyle contributes to obesity and heart disease.

Collocation	Use it like this
balanced diet	A balanced diet matters more than any supplement.
mental well-being	Employers now recognise mental well-being as a productivity issue.
preventive healthcare	Preventive healthcare saves far more than it costs.
public health campaign	A well-designed public health campaign can change habits within months.

Work & Economy

Collocation	Use it like this
job security	Automation threatens the job security of clerical workers.
work-life balance	Remote work improved work-life balance for many employees.
competitive salary	A competitive salary alone no longer retains young talent.
economic growth	Economic growth means little unless ordinary households feel it.
career prospects	Internships often open better career prospects than extra degrees.

Society & Cities

Collocation	Use it like this
urban sprawl	Uncontrolled urban sprawl swallows farmland around every major city.
affordable housing	The shortage of affordable housing pushes workers to the outskirts.
traffic congestion	Traffic congestion costs Dhaka billions in lost productivity.
social cohesion	Mixed neighbourhoods strengthen social cohesion.
an ageing population	An ageing population will strain pension systems worldwide.

Adverb upgrades for Task 2

- very important → **pivotal, indispensable, paramount**
- very big → **substantial, considerable, profound**
- very bad → **detrimental, adverse, severe**
- very good → **beneficial, advantageous, invaluable**
- very fast → **unprecedented, exponential, meteoric** (for growth)

Retention rule: a word is 'yours' only after you have used it in speaking AND writing. Pick five collocations from this sheet each day, force all five into today's practice essay, then recycle them in tomorrow's Speaking Club. Five a day for a month = 150 chunks.